

Optimus Maximus Launch-us Finally-us

This one clearly takes the I-almost-became-vapourware award—the Optimus keyboard (which we've drooled over before) will finally launch in September, at the elevated price of \$1490. They didn't have it at the booth for us, but here's what we know for sure: it'll have 104 black-and-white OLED screens that can be used for any key map you can conceive. The screens themselves won't be the keys—they'll have transparent plastic enclosures that slide around them instead, which should shield the OLEDs from the kind of damage constant pounding can do. They're accepting pre-orders from April, so it's *definitely* releasing, the guys at Art.Lebedev Design tell us.

In the meanwhile, we played with this curiously shaped mouse—the Mus. If anything could set off the alarms at the Ergonomics Police Headquarters, it has to be this. Hurrah for pointless cool!

More Gaming Realism

Professor Philipp Slusallek, Head Brain at the Centre for Excellence in Computer Science at Saarland University, showed off his algorithm for real-time raytracing in games and other applications. The system uses a platform called OpenRT, based on OpenGL, and will enable graphics chips (NVIDIA's G80 onwards) to render complex reflections, refractions and shadows in real time. One of the projects based on the system is Quake 3 Raytraced (and you know how we love *Quake III* here at *Digit*), and we were quite amazed at the demo. Frame rates hover around the 24–25 fps mark, and the Prof admits it's going to need some work before game developers can use this engine. However, "since games take more than two years to develop, the engine will be ready by the time the game is," says he. Exciting stuff, this. Incidentally, you can find a video and screenshots of Quake 3 Raytraced at <http://graphics.cs.uni-sb.de/~sidapohl/egoshooter/>

NEC Does It Again

NEC's prototype Dew camera hangs around your neck, and senses your mood by analysing your voice or any other miscellaneous sounds you might be making. When it senses happiness, it promptly takes a snap, deducing that you'd need to keep that happy memory on record. You can then view your photos on the viewer, which recognises hand gestures to navigate through your collection.

Also on display was the LatticeKey interface for mobile phones, which they hope will pave the way for new and more innovative user interfaces where you're more worried about content than the key you're pressing. The keys are arranged in (what else?) a lattice, with no labels. A guide will pop up on screen when you touch it, and instinct should take it from there. Pity they don't offer us hands-on demos.

